

Week 6 at a Glance

Wednesday–Saturday, October 14 – 17, 2026 · about two hours each morning · AO Year 2 Term 1 week 6

EVERY SCHOOL DAY

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min (monarchs passing through)
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate (Fri lighter — Exodus done)
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray’s New Practical Arithmetic, next lesson (13–16), 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

HOLD ALL WEEK

Copywork: Three jolly gentlemen, / In coats of red,

Recitation: Genesis 1:1 ESV — from your physical Bible; wording not printed here. Optional: say last week’s “The Horseman” by heart.

Hymn: first stanza of “I Bind Unto Myself Today”

Folk song: “The Bold Grenadier”

Math: Ray’s Lessons 13–16. One lesson each school day. Oral first. Do not dump the book.

DAY	BIBLE	MAIN READING	RICHES / EXTRA
Wed 14	Exodus 15 + Awana	Our Island Story ch. 26, Death of William	Ray’s L13 · copywork · hymn · “The Huntsmen”
Thu 15	Exodus 16 + Awana	Little Duke, ch. 3 second half	Harvey’s · Tree in the Trail ch. 4 · folk
Fri 16	— (Exodus finished)	Burgess Animal Book ch. 6	Grimm · Ray’s L15 · picture study
Sat 17	Luke 20:19–26	Understood Betsy ch. 5	Harvey’s · Pilgrim’s Progress · evening walk

Books to have open

- ESV Bible (physical copy — passages by reference only; no verse text printed)
- Ray’s New Practical Arithmetic (Mott) — Lessons 13–16
- Harvey’s Elementary Grammar (Mott) — two short sittings
- Our Island Story, ch. 26 (printed)
- The Little Duke, ch. 3 second half (printed)
- Tree in the Trail — ch. 4 from **your copy** (not printed; still catching up)
- Grimm’s Pantheon — one gentle tale by title (not printed)
- Burgess Animal Book, ch. 6 (ch. 7 printed, optional) · Understood Betsy, ch. 5
- Awana workbook (Wed + Thu only, physical book)

Two children

Astoria does the whole morning. Tracy joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, picture study, Grimm, and outside — see the Preschool corner page. During math, copywork, and heavier history she plays nearby with McGuffey pictures.

Weather

Bastrop mid-October: cooler mornings at last, still warm by noon. Outside early or after 5pm. Times slide; keep the order.

This week’s shifts

Island Story returns with ch. 26 (moved here from Week 5). No CHOW and no Trial and Triumph this week — AO doesn’t call for either. Geography stays Tree in the Trail catch-up ch. 4. Burgess picks up at ch. 6. No Cooper chapter.

Books on the shelf (and what waits)

What the house owns, what is assigned this week, and what waits. Copyrighted books are never reprinted.

YOU OWN THESE · USE FROM THE PHYSICAL COPY

Tree in the Trail (Holling) — catch-up this week: ch. 4 (~15–20 min, Thursday). Still catching up after chapters 1–3 — do **not** jump to AO's later Trail chapters (not ch. 8–9). Never reprint.

Trial and Triumph (Hannula) — not assigned this week. Alfred was Week 5. AO's next is Anselm, around Week 9. Shelf only. Never reprint.

Seabird (Holling) — owned. Hold until AO around Week 19. Shelf only until then.

Hillyer, A Child's History of the World — not assigned this week (AO has no CHOW in Week 6). Next CHOW sitting is around Week 7, from your copy.

SHELF WEAVE THIS WEEK · INSIDE THE SAME MORNING

- **Ray's New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 13–16; one lesson each school day; oral first.
- **Harvey's Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — two ~10 min sittings (Thu + Sat), next lesson from your place.
- **Grimm's Pantheon** — one short gentle tale by title (e.g. "The Bremen Town Musicians" or "Sweet Porridge"). Open your Pantheon. Never reprint.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — Tracy's informal picture-page while Astoria does copywork or math.
- **Awana workbook** — Wed + Thu only, 10–15 min AFTER Bible, next page in the physical book. Never reprint.

BUY-AHEAD / LATER THIS YEAR

Nothing to buy for Weeks 7–9. Everything AO schedules in those weeks is either public domain (printed in the packets) or already on your shelf (Hillyer, *Trial and Triumph*, *Tree in the Trail*). Diane Stanley's *Joan of Arc* is still about Weeks 22–25 away, too early to buy. The library is fine for picture study or composer listening.

No Cooper chapter this week. Charlotte Mason reminders are on the next page instead.

How to sit with them this week

Short lessons. One reading. Narration. Atmosphere. No teacher-book chapter to finish.

01 Narration is the lesson

Read once. Close the book. Let Astoria tell it back. Do not interrupt or prompt with “and then what?” A few true sentences are enough. Thank her. Do not grade it.

02 Short lessons

Fifteen to twenty minutes. Stop while she still wants more. Ray’s is one lesson. Island Story is one chapter. Do not put history and Little Duke in the same hour.

03 One reading

Read it carefully once. If you re-read “to make sure she got it,” she learns she doesn’t have to listen the first time. Trust the narration.

04 Wait

After you close the book, wait a full ten seconds before you speak. Silence is not failure. It is the mind at work.

05 Atmosphere

The room teaches. Calm voice, tidy table, no rushing or shaming. If the morning falls apart, a song and a walk still count as school. Pick up tomorrow.

06 Two children

Tracy joins the stories, songs, poems, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, and nature. She is not expected to narrate. Quiet play or McGuffey pictures during math and copywork.

07 Keep the shelf books light

Ray’s, Harvey’s, Awana, Grimm, and TITT fit into the same morning, not a second school day. Awana only Wed and Thu, after Bible.

08 Habit of attention

Mid-term is when attention drifts. Keep lessons short rather than longer. A finished short lesson builds the habit; a dragged-out one wears it down.

How to teach this week

Island Story is back. Little Duke finishes chapter 3. Exodus 15–16. No CHOW, no Trial and Triumph.

01 Bible without a sermon

Wednesday: Exodus 15. AO lets you skip the Song of Moses (15:1–18), so you may read only 15:19–27 (Marah and Elim) and sing or read the song another day. Thursday: Exodus 16, manna and quail; it is long, so read once and narrate the main thread. Saturday: Luke 20:19–26, the question about paying taxes to Caesar. Friday: no third Exodus chapter. Open your ESV; never print verse text.

02 Awana, Wed and Thu only

Ten to fifteen minutes AFTER Bible. Next page in their physical Awana book. Never reprint Awana. No Awana Fri or Sat.

03 Ray's Lessons 13–16

Continue after Week 5's Lessons 9–12. One lesson each school day. Oral first when the book allows. Do not dump pages. Tracy plays nearby with McGuffey pictures.

04 Copywork and recitation

New line from de la Mare's "The Huntsmen": *Three jolly gentlemen, / In coats of red*, Best handwriting, then stop. Recitation stays Genesis 1:1 from your ESV (reference only here). Optional: have her say "The Horseman" by heart, since she copied it last week.

05 Island Story ch. 26 • Death of William

Moved here from Week 5. Printed in full. One sitting Wednesday. Narrate the New Forest, the curfew bell, the Domesday Book, and how William died. **Intensity note:** one sentence describes the cruel forest-law punishments. Read ahead, and soften or skip that line if you need to.

06 No CHOW • no Trial and Triumph

AO Week 6 has no Hillyer and no Hannula. Week 4 already covered Vikings/Leif and Week 5 covered Alfred. Do not reassign them. Island Story is all the history this week.

07 Little Duke, ch. 3 second half

After the homage, the barons go looking for Duke William's "greatest treasure" and find a monk's robe and sandals. Abbot Martin tells why. Then tired Richard runs to Fru Astrida. Printed. Keep it to about 20 minutes. Have her narrate what was in the chest and why it was his treasure.

08 Tree in the Trail, ch. 4

From **your copy**. One sitting Thursday, ~15–20 min. Still catching up (Weeks 3–5 were ch. 1–3). Do **not** jump to AO's later chapters. Never reprint TITT.

09 Harvey's, twice

Two ~10-minute sittings (Thu and Sat), the next lesson from where you stopped. Oral and light. Do not dump the book.

10 Grimm by title only

Open your Pantheon. One short gentle tale, such as "The Bremen Town Musicians" or "Sweet Porridge." Avoid a gruesome tale. Never reprint.

11 Burgess, one chapter (two if it goes well)

Ch. 6, "Striped Chipmunk and his Cousins," is the week's chapter. AO pairs two chapters this week; ch. 7, "Johnny Chuck Joins the Class," is printed as an optional second sitting. If you skip ch. 7, it opens next week.

12 What you are not doing

No Cooper chapter. No CHOW. No Trial and Triumph. No Seabird until ~Week 19. No Parables from Nature. No jumping ahead in Tree in the Trail. No new novel; Wind in the Willows is finished.

How to teach this week

Betsy, Pilgrim's Progress, poetry, mid-October riches.

13 Understood Betsy ch. 5

"What Grade Is Betsy?" Betsy finds that at this school she can be in different grades for different subjects. It's a long chapter (printed in full), so stop at 20 minutes. Finish later the same day or at bedtime. Narrate what surprised Betsy about her new school.

14 Pilgrim's Progress, Worldly Wiseman

Continues right where Week 5 stopped. Mr. Worldly Wiseman points Christian to Mr. Legality in the village of Morality, Christian turns aside to the hill, and he is afraid. About 1,000 words printed, ending with Bunyan's four-line verse. Stop there; Evangelist arrives next week.

15 Poetry: "The Huntsmen"

Walter de la Mare, *Peacock Pie*. Three jolly gentlemen ride their horses up to bed. Read it once; both children will enjoy the "clitter-clatter." Copywork comes from the opening.

16 Dictation (optional, Saturday)

If copywork is going well: have her look at *In coats of red*, until she can see it with her eyes shut, then write it as you say it once. Five minutes. Skip it if she's tired.

17 Term 1 riches

Hymn: first stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today" (start the second only if the first is solid). Folk: "The Bold Grenadier," clean verses. Picture study: Rockwell, *Freedom of Worship*, the next of the Four Freedoms after six weeks of *Freedom of Speech*. Look, turn it over, and have her describe it. Composer: Bernstein, *Jeremiah*; try movement II, "Profanation," for five to eight minutes. Nothing copyrighted is printed.

18 Nature

Lost Pines, mid-October. Monarchs move through Central Texas about now; watch for them on asters, goldenrod, and frostweed. Note the first cool fronts, acorns, and pine cones. Watch for fire ants. In the nature notebook: draw, date, and write one sentence for her.

19 If it falls apart

Skip to outdoor time. Keep Bible (on Bible days), Ray's, and that day's main reading. Riches can wait. A song and a walk still count.

20 Check-up scores

If you haven't sent September's check-up scores yet, a photo of the score sheet any time this week is perfect. The October check-up comes with the first packet in November.

Tracy's week

No lessons, no narration, no check-up. She belongs at the table and outside; she is never required to sit.

01 Join in

Nature sits and walks, Bible (as long as she'll sit), the hymn and "The Bold Grenadier," "The Huntsmen," Burgess chipmunks and woodchucks, the Grimm tale, picture study. If she wanders off, let her.

02 McGuffey picture-page

While Astoria does Ray's or copywork: one page of the Mott McGuffey Pictorial Primer. Point and name ("cat," "hat"). Let her turn the page. No drilling and no letters required. Then crayons or play nearby.

03 "The Huntsmen" game

Say the poem while she gallops her hands on the table: "up to bed" (hands under cheek), "snored" (snore), "clitter-clatter down the stairs" (fast drumming). Twice is plenty.

04 Busy-hands basket

Put out a small basket of acorns, pine cones, and smooth sticks to sort or line up during math. Always within arm's reach (choking caution for small acorns).

05 Outside is her classroom

Monarch watching, picking up pine cones, splashing at the creek edge with a grown-up. Name one thing each day: "monarch," "acorn," "ant."

06 What Tracy is not doing

No worksheets, no recitation, no scoring. If she's fussy, the mornings take the order of the day and nothing more.

Wednesday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana workbook · hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 13) · copywork line · *Our Island Story* ch. 26 (printed) · "The Huntsmen" · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

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- 8:00** **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS
Backyard or porch, twenty minutes. Pick one thing: a monarch, an acorn, a bird call. Look at it. Sketch if they want.
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- 8:25** **Bible · Exodus 15**
Open your ESV to Exodus 15. Read 15:19–27 (Marah and Elim). The song in 15:1–18 is optional. Read once, close the Bible, narrate, then stop.
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- 8:40** **Awana** AFTER BIBLE
Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page in the physical Awana book. Never reprint.
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- 8:55** **Hymn** TRACY JOINS
First stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today." Sing it; don't explain it to death.
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- 9:05** **Ray's · Lesson 13**
Next lesson after Week 5's Lesson 12. Oral first. One lesson. Tracy: McGuffey picture-page or busy-hands basket.
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- 9:25** **Copywork + recitation**
Copywork: *Three jolly gentlemen, / In coats of red*, Recitation: Genesis 1:1 from your ESV (wording not printed).
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- 9:40** **History · Island Story ch. 26**
"The Death of William the Conqueror." Printed. Cap ~20 min. Preview the forest-laws line. Narrate. **Stop.** No CHOW this week.
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- 10:10** **Poem · "The Huntsmen"** TRACY JOINS
Read once. Both children. No talk afterward unless they start it.
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How to teach Wednesday

Island Story is back. Ch. 26 printed in full. No CHOW and no Trial and Triumph this week.

Bible and Awana

Exodus 15 is enough. If you skip the Song of Moses, start at verse 19: bitter water made sweet at Marah, then the twelve springs at Elim. Awana after Bible, physical book only, then put it away.

Ray's Lesson 13

Pick up the Mott Ray's where Week 5 stopped. Oral first. Stop after one lesson even if she's eager.

Island Story

William is master of England, but the English never love him. The chapter covers the New Forest, the curfew bell ("cover fire"), the Domesday Book, the feudal system, and his lonely death and burial. Let her tell it in her own order. A timeline mark for 1087 is a nice extra.

Poem

"The Huntsmen" is this week's poem and where the copywork comes from. Read it for fun.

Tracy: nature, Bible as long as she'll sit, hymn, poem. McGuffey or the busy-hands basket during Ray's and copywork. She can listen to Island Story if she's still; she doesn't narrate.

Bible · Exodus 15

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Exodus 15.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.

Marah and Elim (15:19–27). The Song of Moses (15:1–18) is optional per AO.

Our Island Story · Chapter 26 · The Death of William the Conqueror

H. E. Marshall, Our Island Story. Public-domain text (archive.org scan, page headers removed). Full chapter. Moved here from Week 5.

CHAPTER XXVI · THE DEATH OF WILLIAM THE CONQUEROR

William was ruler of the land, but English hearts never accepted him. Norman and Englishman lived side by side, yet a wide sea of hatred kept them apart.

As he had promised, William rewarded the Norman barons and nobles who had helped him to conquer England. He gave them the lands and goods of the conquered people, so it was not wonderful that there was fierce hatred between the two races.

The Normans were greedy, and they not only took the lands which William gave them, but they forced the English to pay large sums of money too. Every high position was filled by Normans, and the English were forced to be the servants and slaves of these proud Norman masters.

The Normans talked a great deal of 'right,' but the more they talked of right, the more wrong they did. The very sheriffs and judges, who ought to have seen that the laws were kept and that justice was done, were more greedy than thieves and robbers, and the king was greediest of all. He made the people pay tolls and taxes until they had hardly any money left. Much of this money he took away with him to France, much he kept locked up in his strong treasure-room.

As if he had not already spoiled enough of the country in battle, William next laid waste a great part in the south, simply because he was very fond of hunting and he wanted a good hunting-ground. He turned the people out of their houses, burning and ruining whole villages in order to make a great place in which to ride and hunt. He called this place the New Forest and it is so called to this day.

Having made this forest, William also made forest laws. These laws were very cruel. If any person was found hunting or killing the deer or other wild animals, his eyes were put out or his hands and ears were cut off. So the poor people, who had been driven from their homes, dared not even kill the wild animals for food.

William did not do much that was kind, but some things which he did were wise. Among the wise things was the law which he made that all lights and fires must be put out at eight o'clock at night.

Nowadays we should think it very hard indeed if all fires and lights had to be put out at eight o'clock. But in those days people used to rise very early, and go to bed very early, so that it was not a great hardship. It was really a wise rule, because nearly all the houses were built of wood, and if people were careless and went to bed leaving large fires burning, the houses were apt to catch fire. In a town all built of wood, if one house caught fire sometimes a whole street would be burned to the ground before the fire could be put out.

By this wise law William made the danger of fires much less. Every night at eight o'clock a bell was rung. This bell was called 'the curfew,' from the French words 'couvre feu,' which mean 'cover fire.'

Another wise thing which William did was to make what is called the Domesday Book, or book of judgement. This was a very big book in which a description of all the great houses and lands in the kingdom was written down, with the names of the people to whom the land and houses belonged. This book was very useful at the time, and it has been very useful since. For one thing it shows us how much land was taken from the English and given to the Normans.

When William gave the Normans land he did not give it to them for nothing. In return they had to promise to come to help the King in battle and to bring men with them. The more land they got the more men they had to promise to provide in time of war. When William wished to know how many men a certain lord would bring to fight for him, he only needed to look at his great book to see how much land he had. This plan of paying for land by fighting was called the feudal system, and it lasted in England for many years.

William spent a great deal of time in Normandy, for, though he was proud to be King of England, he loved his Norman home far better. It was in Normandy that he died.

William had been fighting with the King of France, and, with his usual cruelty, he had burned a town belonging to that king. While William was riding about among the ruins, his horse stepped upon some hot ashes, stumbled, and he was thrown to the ground. William was by this time very fat and old, and the fall hurt him so much that in a few days he died.

Only two of William's sons were with him at the time. Robert, the eldest, had quarrelled with his father long before, and was far away. But, as he lay dying, William wished to be at peace with every one. He forgave Robert and left the crown of Normandy to him. 'And,' he said, 'although the crown of England is not mine to give away, I should like William to have it.' And the son, eager to claim his father's crown, seized the great signet ring which the dying king still wore, and drew it from his finger.

To Henry, his youngest son, William left a large sum of money.

Then William and Henry hurried off to England; the one to demand the crown, the other to make sure of his treasure. The great Conqueror was left to die alone.

A strange thing happened while William was being buried. Fire broke out in the streets just as it had done when he was being crowned. The people who were carrying the bier fled, so once more the Conqueror was left alone with a few priests. They would have buried him hurriedly but, as they began the service, a young man stepped forward and stopped them. 'This ground,' he said, 'was taken from my father by the very king whom you now wish to bury here. He has no right to the land. It is mine, not his. I refuse to allow him to be buried in it.'

So even in death the Conqueror was to find no resting-place. But the priests bargained with the young man, and at last, for the sum of sixty shillings, he allowed them to bury the King in his ground.

And there the Conqueror was at last laid to rest.

Stop here. End of chapter. Ch. 27, William the Red, is AO Week 7.

The Huntsmen

Walter de la Mare, Peacock Pie. Project Gutenberg eBook #3753. Public domain. This week's copywork comes from here.

Three jolly gentlemen,

In coats of red,

Rode their horses

Up to bed.

Three jolly gentlemen

Snored till morn,

Their horses champing

The golden corn.

Three jolly gentlemen,

At break of day,

Came clitter-clatter down the stairs

And galloped away.

Thursday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana · folk song · Ray's (Lesson 14) · *The Little Duke* ch. 3 second half · Harvey's · *Tree in the Trail* (your copy, ch. 4) · McGuffey nearby

8:00 **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Ten minutes if Wednesday's sit went well. Or skip it and save the long walk for Saturday evening.

8:15 **Bible · Exodus 16**

Open your ESV to Exodus 16: manna and quail. Long chapter. Read once, narrate the main thread, and stop if time runs out.

8:35 **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page. Physical book only. Last Awana day this week.

8:50 **Folk song** TRACY JOINS

"The Bold Grenadier." Clean verses only. Sing; don't lecture.

9:00 **Ray's, copywork, recitation**

Lesson 14. Copywork line from "The Huntsmen." Genesis 1:1 from your ESV. Tracy: McGuffey or busy-hands basket.

9:30 **Tales · Little Duke, ch. 3 second half**

Printed: the key, the chest, and what Duke William's "greatest treasure" really was. Cap ~20 min. Narrate what was in the chest and why.

9:55 **Harvey's · ~10 min**

Next lesson from where you stopped. Oral and light. Do not dump the book.

10:10 **Geography · Tree in the Trail ch. 4**

From **your copy**. ~15–20 min. Still catching up; do not jump ahead. Never reprint.

How to teach Thursday

TITT from your copy only. Do not reprint Holling. Do not jump past catch-up to AO's later Trail chapters.

Bible and Awana

Exodus 16 has grumbling, then manna each morning and none on the Sabbath. Do one reading and get a clear narration. Awana after Bible, then put the workbook away until next Wednesday.

Little Duke

This finishes chapter 3. The key found on Duke William opens a chest holding only a monk's robe and sandals. Abbot Martin explains that William longed to serve God in the cloister but was told to keep doing his duty as ruler. It's a quiet, tender ending, so let her sit with it. Chapter 4 begins in Week 7.

Tree in the Trail

Ch. 4 catch-up. One sitting. Don't add a second chapter today.

Harvey's

Ten minutes. Keep going from your place. Stop while she's still willing.

Tracy: Bible as long as she'll sit, folk song. Quiet play during Ray's, copywork, Little Duke, and Harvey's. She can look at the TITT pictures with Astoria.

READ THIS · THURSDAY

Bible · Exodus 16

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Exodus 16.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.

Manna and quail. Long chapter. Read once and stop if time runs out.

The Little Duke · Chapter 3 · second half

Charlotte M. Yonge. Project Gutenberg eBook #3048. Public domain. Picks up right after Week 5's stopping point (Duke Alan's farewell).

CHAPTER III · CONTINUED

“Fair words, but I trust not the Breton,” muttered Bernard; “hatred is deeply ingrained in them.”

“He should know what the Frank King is made of,” said Rainulf de Ferrieres; “he was bred up with him in the days that they were both exiles at the court of King Ethelstane of England.”

“Ay, and thanks to Duke William that either Louis or Alan are not exiles still. Now we shall see whose gratitude is worth most, the Frank's or the Breton's. I suspect the Norman valour will be the best to trust to.”

“Yes, and how will Norman valour prosper without treasure? Who knows what gold is in the Duke's coffers?”

There was some consultation here in a low voice, and the next thing Richard heard distinctly was, that one of the Nobles held up a silver chain and key, saying that they had been found on the Duke's neck, and that he had kept them, thinking that they doubtless led to something of importance.

“Oh, yes!” said Richard, eagerly, “I know it. He told me it was the key to his greatest treasure.”

The Normans heard this with great interest, and it was resolved that several of the most trusted persons, among whom were the Archbishop of Rouen, Abbot Martin of Jumieges, and the Count of Harcourt, should go immediately in search of this precious hoard. Richard accompanied them up the narrow rough stone stairs, to the large dark apartment, where his father had slept. Though a Prince's chamber, it had little furniture; a low uncurtained bed, a Cross on a ledge near its head, a rude table, a few chairs, and two large chests, were all it contained. Harcourt tried the lid of one of the chests: it opened, and proved to be full of wearing apparel; he went to the other, which was smaller, much more carved, and ornamented with very handsome iron-work. It was locked, and putting in the key, it fitted, the lock turned, and the chest was opened. The Normans pressed eagerly to see their Duke's greatest treasure.

It was a robe of serge, and a pair of sandals, such as were worn in the Abbey of Jumieges.

“Ha! is this all? What didst say, child?” cried Bernard the Dane, hastily.

“He told me it was his greatest treasure!” repeated Richard.

“And it was!” said Abbot Martin.

Then the good Abbot told them the history, part of which was already known to some of them. About five or six years before, Duke William had been hunting in the forest of Jumieges, when he had suddenly come on the ruins of the Abbey, which had been wasted thirty or forty years previously by the Sea-King, Hasting. Two old monks, of the original brotherhood, still survived, and came forth to greet the Duke, and offer him their hospitality.

“Ay!” said Bernard, “well do I remember their bread; we asked if it was made of fir-bark, like that of our brethren of Norway.”

William, then an eager, thoughtless young man, turned with disgust from this wretched fare, and throwing the old men some gold, galloped on to enjoy his hunting. In the course of the sport, he was left alone, and encountered a wild boar, which threw him down, trampled on him, and left him stretched senseless on the ground, severely injured. His companions coming up, carried him, as the nearest place of shelter, to the ruins of Jumieges, where the two old monks gladly received him in the remaining portion of their house. As soon as he recovered his senses, he earnestly asked their pardon for his pride, and the scorn he had shown to the poverty and patient suffering which he should have revered.

William had always been a man who chose the good and refused the evil, but this accident, and the long illness that followed it, made him far more thoughtful and serious than he had ever been before; he made preparing for death and eternity his first object, and thought less of his worldly affairs, his wars, and his ducal state. He rebuilt the old Abbey, endowed it richly, and sent for Martin himself from France, to become the Abbot; he delighted in nothing so much as praying there, conversing with the Abbot, and hearing him read holy books; and he felt his temporal affairs, and the state and splendour of his rank, so great a temptation, that he had one day come to the Abbot, and entreated to be allowed to lay them aside, and become a brother of the order. But Martin had refused to receive his vows. He had told him that he had no right to neglect or forsake the duties of the station which God had appointed him; that it would be a sin to leave the post which had been given him to defend; and that the way marked out for him to serve God was by doing justice among his people, and using his power to defend the right. Not till he had done his allotted work, and his son was old enough to take his place as ruler of the Normans, might he cease from his active duties, quit the turmoil of the world, and seek the repose of the cloister. It was in this hope of peaceful retirement, that William had delighted to treasure up the humble garments that he hoped one day to wear in peace and holiness.

“And oh! my noble Duke!” exclaimed Abbot Martin, bursting into tears, as he finished his narration, “the Lord hath been very gracious unto thee! He has taken thee home to thy rest, long before thou didst dare to hope for it.”

Slowly, and with subdued feelings, the Norman Barons left the chamber; Richard, whom they seemed to have almost forgotten, wandered to the stairs, to find his way to the room where he had slept last night. He had not made many steps before he heard Osmond’s voice say, “Here, my Lord;” he looked up, saw a white cap at a doorway a little above him, he bounded up and flew into Dame Astrida’s outstretched arms.

How glad he was to sit in her lap, and lay his wearied head on her bosom, while, with a worn-out voice, he exclaimed, “Oh, Fru Astrida! I am very, very tired of being Duke of Normandy!”

Stop here. End of chapter 3. Chapter 4 begins in Week 7.

Tree in the Trail · Chapter 4

From your physical book · never reprinted in this packet

Open your copy of *Tree in the Trail* to chapter 4.

One sitting, about 15–20 minutes. Read once. Narrate. Then stop.

Still catching up (Week 3 ch. 1, Week 4 ch. 2, Week 5 ch. 3). Do **not** jump to AO's later chapters. Never reprint Holling.

Optional: trace the Trail on a simple map of the plains with your finger.

OPEN YOUR COPY · THURSDAY

Harvey's Elementary Grammar · short sitting

From your physical book · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Mott Media Harvey's.

About ten minutes. Next lesson from last week's place. Oral and light. Do not dump the book.

Second Harvey's sitting is Saturday.

Friday

HAVE READY

Hymn · Ray's (Lesson 15) · Burgess ch. 6 (ch. 7 optional) · Grimm Pantheon · Rockwell *Freedom of Worship* · nature notebook

8:00 **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Mid-October in the Lost Pines: monarchs, cooler air, acorns, a pine cone.

8:25 **No third Exodus today**

Exodus 15 and 16 are done. Start with the hymn. (Luke is Saturday.) No Awana today.

8:30 **Hymn, Ray's, copywork, recitation**

Same stanza. Lesson 15. Copywork line. Genesis 1:1 from your ESV. Tracy: McGuffey or busy-hands basket.

9:05 **Nature lore · Burgess ch. 6** TRACY JOINS

"Striped Chipmunk and his Cousins." Printed. Both children. Narrate one true thing about a chipmunk.

9:30 **Grimm · one gentle tale** TRACY JOINS

From your Pantheon, by title only: "The Bremen Town Musicians" or "Sweet Porridge." Never reprint.

9:50 **Picture study · Rockwell**

Freedom of Worship. Look quietly for a few minutes, turn it over, and have her tell what she saw. Library book or a screen is fine. Nothing is printed here.

10:05 **Burgess ch. 7 (optional)**

"Johnny Chuck Joins the Class," only if the morning still has room and she's enjoying it. Otherwise it opens next week.

How to teach Friday

No Awana. No third Exodus chapter. Protect the Burgess narration. Burgess ch. 7 is optional.

Lighter Bible day

The week's Old Testament reading is done. Keep the morning's living books; Saturday has the Gospel reading.

Burgess, then Grimm

Animal lore first, then one gentle Pantheon tale by title. Two separate narrations, not one mashed together.

Picture study

After six weeks with *Freedom of Speech*, start the next of Rockwell's Four Freedoms. One quiet look and a short narration. Don't lecture on the history.

Burgess ch. 7

AO pairs chapters this week. If ch. 6 went well and there's time, read ch. 7 (printed). If not, it opens Week 7. Either way is fine.

Tracy: nature, Burgess, Grimm, picture study. Quiet play during Ray's and copywork.

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 6 · Striped Chipmunk and his Cousins

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CHAPTER VI · STRIPED CHIPMUNK AND HIS COUSINS

Of course there couldn't be a school in the Green Forest without news of it spreading very fast. News travels quickly through the Green Forest and over the Green Meadows, for the little people who live there are great gossips. So it was not surprising that Striped Chipmunk heard all about Old Mother Nature's school. The next morning, just as the daily lesson was beginning, Striped Chipmunk came hurrying up, quite out of breath.

"Well, well! See who's here!" exclaimed Old Mother Nature. "What have you come for, Striped Chipmunk?"

"I've come to try to learn. Will you let me stay, Mother Nature?" replied Striped Chipmunk.

"Of course I'll let you stay," cried Old Mother Nature heartily. "I am glad you have come, especially glad you have come today, because to-day's lesson is to be about you and your cousins. Now, Peter Rabbit, what are the differences between Striped Chipmunk and his cousins, the Tree Squirrels?"

Peter looked very hard at Striped Chipmunk as if he had never really seen him before. "He is smaller than they are," began Peter. "In fact, he is the smallest Squirrel I know." Peter paused.

Old Mother Nature nodded encouragingly. "Go on," said she.

"He wears a striped coat," continued Peter. "The stripes are black and yellowish-white and run along his sides, a black stripe running down the middle of his back. The rest of his coat is reddish-brown above and light underneath. His tail is rather thin and flat. I never see him in the trees, so I guess he can't climb."

"Oh, yes, I can," interrupted Striped Chipmunk. "I can climb if I want to, and I do sometimes, but prefer the ground."

"Go on, Peter," said Old Mother Nature.

"He seems to like old stone walls and rock piles," continued Peter, "and he is one of the brightest, liveliest, merriest and the most lovable of all my friends."

"Thank you, Peter," said Striped Chipmunk softly.

"I never have been able to find his home," continued Peter. "That is one of his secrets. But I know it is in the ground. I guess this is all I know about him. I should say the chief difference between Striped Chipmunk and the Tree Squirrels is that he spends all his time on the ground while the others live largely in the trees."

"Very good, Peter," said Old Mother Nature. "But there are two very important differences which you have not mentioned. Striped Chipmunk has a big pocket on the inside of each cheek, while his cousins of the trees have no pockets at all."

"Of course," cried Peter. "I don't see how I came to forget that. I've laughed many times at Striped Chipmunk with those pockets stuffed with nuts or seeds until his head looked three times bigger than it does now. Those pockets must be very handy."

"They are," replied Striped Chipmunk. "I couldn't get along without them. They save me a lot of running back and forth, I can tell you."

"And the other great difference," said Old Mother Nature, "is that Striped Chipmunk sleeps nearly all winter, just waking up occasionally to pop his head out on a bright day to see how the weather is. A great many folks call Striped Chipmunk a Ground Squirrel, but more properly he is a Rock Squirrel because he likes stony places best. Supposing,

Striped Chipmunk, you tell us where and how you make your home.”

“I make my home down in the ground,” replied Striped Chipmunk. “I dig a tunnel just big enough to run along comfortably. Down deep enough to be out of reach of Jack Frost I make a nice little bedroom with a bed of grass and leaves, and I make another little room for a storeroom in which to keep my supply of seeds and nuts. Sometimes I have more than one storeroom. Also I have some little side tunnels.”

“But why is it I never have been able to find the entrance to your tunnel?” asked Peter, as full of curiosity as ever.

“Because I have it hidden underneath the stone wall on the edge of the Old Orchard,” replied Striped Chipmunk.

“But even then, I should think that all the sand you must have taken out would give your secret away,” cried Peter.

Striped Chipmunk chuckled happily. It was a throaty little chuckle, pleasant to hear. “I looked out for that,” said he. “There isn’t a grain of that sand around my doorway. I took it all out through another hole some distance away, a sort of back door, and then closed it up solidly. If you please, Mother Nature, if I am not a Ground Squirrel, who is?”

“Your cousin, Seek Seek the Sperrophile, sometimes called Gopher Squirrel, who lives on the open plains of the West where there are no rocks or stones. He likes best the flat, open country. He is called Sperrophile because that means seed-eater, and he lives largely on seeds, especially on grain. Because of this he does a great deal of damage and is much disliked by farmers.

“Seek Seek’s family are the true Ground Squirrels. Please remember that they never should be called Gophers, for they are not Gophers. One of the smallest members of the family is just about your size, Striped Chipmunk, and he also wears stripes, only he has more of them than you have, and they are broken up into little dots. He is called the Thirteen-lined Sperrophile. He has pockets in his cheeks just as you have, and he makes a home down in the ground very similar to yours. All the family do this, and all of them sleep through the winter. While they are great seed-eaters they also eat a great many insects and worms, and some of them even are guilty of killing and eating the babies of birds that nest on the ground, and also young mice.

“Some members of the family are almost as big as Happy Jack the Gray Squirrel and have gray coats. They are called Gray Ground Squirrels and sometimes Gray Gophers. One of the largest of these is the California Ground Squirrel. He has a big, bushy tail, very like Happy Jack’s. He gets into so much mischief in the grain fields and in the orchards that he is quite as much disliked as is Jack Rabbit. This particular member of the family is quite as much at home among rocks and tree roots as in open ground. He climbs low trees for fruit and nuts, but prefers to stay on the ground. Now just remember that the Chipmunks are Rock Squirrels and their cousins the Sperrophiles are Ground Squirrels. Now who of you has seen Timmy the Flying Squirrel lately?”

“I haven’t,” said Peter Rabbit.

“I haven’t,” said Striped Chipmunk.

“I haven’t,” said Happy Jack.

“I haven’t,” said Chatterer.

“I have,” spoke up Jumper the Hare. “I saw him last evening just after jolly, round, red Mr. Sun went to bed behind the Purple Hills and the Black Shadows came creeping through the Green Forest. My, I wish I could fly the way he can!”

Old Mother Nature shook her head disapprovingly. “Jumper,” said she, “what is wrong with your eyes? When did you ever see Timmy fly?”

“Last night,” insisted Jumper stubbornly.

“Oh, no, you didn’t,” retorted Old Mother Nature. “You didn’t see him fly, for the very good reason that he cannot fly any more than you can. You saw him simply jump. Just remember that the only animals in this great land who can fly are the Bats. Timmy the Flying Squirrel simply jumps from the top of a tree and slides down on the air to the foot of

another tree. If you had used your eyes you would have noticed that when he is in the air he never moves his legs or arms, and he is always coming down, never going up, excepting for a little at the end of his jump, as would be the case if he could really fly. He hasn't any wings."

"When he's flying, I mean jumping, he looks as if he had wings," insisted Jumper stubbornly.

"That is simply because I have given him a fold of skin between the front and hind leg on each side," explained Old Mother Nature. "When he jumps he stretches his legs out flat, and that stretches out those two folds of skin until they look almost like wings. This is the reason he can sail so far when he jumps from a high place. You've seen a bird, after flapping its wings to get going, sail along with them outstretched and motionless. Timmy does the same thing, only he gets going by jumping. You may have noticed that he usually goes to the top of a tree before jumping; then he can sail down a wonderfully long distance. His tail helps him to keep his balance. If there is anything in the way, he can steer himself around it. When he reaches the tree he is jumping for he shoots up a little way and lands on the trunk not far above the ground. Then he scampers up that tree to do it all over again."

"But why don't we ever see him?" inquired Striped Chipmunk.

"Because, when the rest of you squirrels are out and about, he is curled up in a little ball in his nest, fast asleep. Timmy likes the night, especially the early evening, and doesn't like the light of day."

"How big is he?" asked Happy Jack, and looked a little sheepish as if he were a wee bit ashamed of not being acquainted with one of his own cousins.

"He is, if anything, a little smaller than Striped Chipmunk," replied Old Mother Nature. "Way out in the Far West he grows a little bigger. His coat is a soft yellowish-brown above; beneath he is all white. His fur is wonderfully soft. He has very large, dark, soft eyes, especially suited for seeing at night. Then, he is very lively and dearly loves to play. By nature he is gentle and lovable."

"Does he eat nuts like his cousins?" asked Peter Rabbit.

"He certainly does," replied Old Mother Nature. "Also he eats grubs and insects. He dearly loves a fat beetle. He likes meat when he can get it."

"Where does he make his home?" Peter inquired.

"Usually in a hole in a tree," said Old Mother Nature. "He is very fond of an old home of a Woodpecker. He makes a comfortable nest of bark lining, grass, and moss, or any other soft material he can find. Occasionally he builds an outside nest high up in a fork in the branches of a tree. He likes to get into old buildings."

"Does he have many enemies?" asked Happy Jack.

"The same enemies the rest of you have," replied Old Mother Nature. "But the one he has most reason to fear is Hooty the Owl, and that is the one you have least reason to fear, because Hooty seldom hunts by day."

"Does he sleep all winter?" piped up Striped Chipmunk.

"Not as you do," said Old Mother Nature. "In very cold weather he sleeps, but if he happens to be living where the weather does not get very cold, he is active all the year around. Now I guess this is enough about the Squirrel family."

"You've forgotten Johnny Chuck," cried Peter.

Old Mother Nature laughed. "So I have," said she. "That will never do, never in the world. Johnny and his relatives, the Marmots, certainly cannot be overlooked. We will take them for our lesson to-morrow. Peter, you tell Johnny Chuck to come over here to-morrow morning."

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 7 · Johnny Chuck Joins the Class

Thornton W. Burgess. Project Gutenberg eBook #2441. Public domain. AO pairs ch. 7 with ch. 8; read it only if Friday has room.

CHAPTER VII · JOHNNY CHUCK JOINS THE CLASS

Peter Rabbit delivered Mother Nature's message to Johnny Chuck. Johnny didn't seem at all pleased. He grumbled and growled to himself. He didn't want to go to school. He didn't want to learn anything about his relatives. He was perfectly satisfied with things as they were. The truth is, Johnny Chuck was already beginning to get fat with good living and he is naturally lazy. As a rule he can find plenty to eat very near his home, so he seldom goes far from his own doorstep. Peter left him grumbling and growling, and chuckled to himself all the way back to the dear Old Briar-patch. He knew that Johnny Chuck would not dare disobey Old Mother Nature.

Sure enough, the next morning Johnny Chuck came waddling through the Green Forest just as Old Mother Nature was about to open school. He didn't look at all happy, and he didn't reply at all to the greetings of the others. But when Old Mother Nature spoke to him he was very polite.

"Good morning, Johnny Chuck," said she.

Johnny bobbed his head and said, "Good morning."

"I understand," continued Old Mother Nature, "That you are not at all interested in learning about your relatives. I am sorry for any one who doesn't want to learn. The more one knows the better fitted he is to take care of himself and do his part in the work of the Great World. However, it wasn't for your benefit that I sent word for you to be here this morning. It was for the benefit of your friends and neighbors. Now sit up so that all can get a good look at you."

Johnny Chuck obediently sat up, and of course all the others stared at him. It made him feel quite uncomfortable. "You remember," said Old Mother Nature, "how surprised you little folks were when I told you that Johnny Chuck is a member of the Squirrel family. Happy Jack, you go sit beside Johnny Chuck, and the rest of you look hard at Happy Jack and Johnny and see if you do not see a family resemblance."

Seeing Happy Jack and Johnny Chuck sitting up side by side, Peter Rabbit caught the resemblance at once. There was sort of family look about them. "Why! Why-ee! Johnny Chuck does look like a Squirrel," he exclaimed.

"Of course he looks like a Squirrel, because he is one," said Old Mother Nature. "Johnny Chuck is very much bigger and so stout in the body that he has none of the gracefulness of the true Squirrels. But you will notice that the shape of his head is much the same as that of Happy Jack. He has a Squirrel face when you come to look at him closely. The Woodchucks, sometimes called Ground Hogs, though why any one should call them this is more than I can understand, belong to the Marmot branch of the Squirrel family, and wherever found they look much alike.

"As you will notice, Johnny Chuck's coat is brownish-yellow, his feet are very dark brown, almost black. His head is dark brown with light gray on his cheeks. Beneath he is reddish-orange, including his throat. His tail is short for a member of the Squirrel family, and although it is bushy, it is not very big. He has a number of whiskers and they are black. Some Woodchucks are quite gray, and occasionally there is one who is almost, or wholly black, just as there are black Gray Squirrels.

"Johnny, here, is not fond of the Green Forest, but loves the Old orchard and the Green Meadows. In some parts of the country there are members of his family who prefer to live just on the edge of the Green Forest. You will notice that Johnny has stout claws. Those are to help him dig, for all the Marmot family are great diggers. What other use do you have for those claws, Johnny?"

"They help me to climb," replied Johnny promptly.

“Climb!” exclaimed Peter Rabbit. “Who ever heard of a Woodchuck climbing?”

“I can climb if I have to,” retorted Johnny Chuck indignantly. “I’ve climbed up bushes and low trees lots of times, and if I can get a good run first, I can climb up the straight trunk of a tree with rough bark to the first branches--if they are not too far above ground. You ask Reddy Fox if I can’t; he knows.”

“That’s quite true, Johnny,” said Old Mother Nature. “You can climb a little, but as a real climber you are not much of a success. You are better as a digger.”

“He certainly is all right as a digger,” exclaimed Peter Rabbit. “My, how he can make the sand fly! Johnny Chuck certainly is right at home when it comes to digging.”

“You ought to be thankful that he is,” said Old Mother Nature, “for the holes he has dug have saved your life more than once. By the way, Peter, since you are so well acquainted with those holes, suppose you tell us what kind of a home Johnny Chuck has.”

Peter was delighted to air his knowledge. “The last one I was in,” said he, “was a long tunnel slanting down for quite a distance and then straightening out. The entrance was quite large with a big heap of sand out in front of it. Down a little way the tunnel grew smaller and then remained the same size all the rest of the way. Way down at the farther end was a nice little bedroom with some grass in it. There were one or two other little rooms, and there were two branch tunnels leading up to the surface of the ground, making side or back doorways. There was no sand around either of these, and they were quite hidden by the long grass hanging over them. I don’t understand how Johnny made those doorways without leaving any sand on the doorsteps.”

“Huh!” interrupted Johnny Chuck. “That was easy enough. I pushed all the sand out of the main doorway so that there would be nothing to attract the attention of any one passing near those back doorways. Those back doorways are very handy in time of danger.”

“Do you always have three doorways?” asked Happy Jack.

“No,” replied Johnny Chuck. “Sometimes I have only two and once in a while only one. But that isn’t really safe, and I mean always to have at least two.”

“Do you use the same house year after year?” piped up Striped Chipmunk.

Johnny shook his head. “No,” said he. “I dig a new hole each spring. Mrs. Chuck and I like a change of scene. Usually my new home isn’t very far from my old one, because I am not fond of traveling. Sometimes, however, if we cannot find a place that just suits us, we go quite a distance.”

“Are your babies born down in that little bedroom in the ground?” asked Jumper the Hare.

“Of course,” replied Johnny Chuck. “Where else would they be born?”

“I didn’t know but Mrs. Chuck might make a nest on the ground the way Mrs. Peter and Mrs. Jumper do,” replied Jumper meekly.

“No, siree!” replied Johnny. “Our babies are born in that little underground bedroom, and they stay down in the ground until they are big enough to hunt for food for themselves.”

“How many do you usually have?” inquired Chatterer the Red Squirrel.

“Six or eight,” replied Johnny Chuck. “Mrs. Chuck and I believe in large families.”

“Do you eat nuts like the rest of our family?” inquired Striped Chipmunk.

“No,” replied Johnny Chuck. “Give me green food every time. There is nothing so good as tender sweet clover and young grass, unless it be some of those fine vegetables Farmer Brown grows in his garden.”

Peter Rabbit nodded his head very emphatically as if he quite agreed.

“I suppose you are what is called a vegetarian, then,” said Happy Jack, to which Johnny Chuck replied that he supposed he was. “And I suppose that is why you sleep all winter,” added Happy Jack.

“If I didn’t I would starve,” responded Johnny Chuck promptly. “When it gets near time for Jack Frost to arrive, I stuff and stuff and stuff on the last of the good green things until I’m so fat I can hardly waddle. Then I go down to my bedroom, curl up and go to sleep. Cold weather, snow and ice don’t worry me a bit.”

“I know,” spoke up Striped Chipmunk. “I sleep most of the winter myself. Of course I have a lot of food stored away down in my house, and once in a while I wake up and eat a little. Do you ever wake up in the winter, Johnny Chuck?”

“No,” replied Johnny. “I sleep right through, thank goodness. Sometimes I wake up very early in the spring before the snow is all gone, earlier than I wish I did. That is where my fat comes in handy. It keeps me warm and keeps me alive until I can find the first green plants. Perhaps you have noticed that early in the spring I am as thin as I was fat in the fall. This is because I have used up the fat, waiting for the first green things to appear.”

“Do you have many enemies?” asked Peter Rabbit, who has so many himself that he is constantly thinking of them.

“Not many, but enough,” growled Johnny Chuck. “Reddy Fox, Old Man Coyote, men and Dogs are the worst. Of course, when I was small I always had to be watching out for Hawks, and of course, like all the rest of us little folks, I am afraid of Shadow the Weasel. Reddy Fox has tried to dig me out more than once, but I can dig faster than he can. If he ever gets me cornered, he’ll find that I can fight. A small Dog surprised me once before I could get to my hole and I guess that Dog never will tackle another Woodchuck.”

“Time is up,” interrupted Old Mother Nature. “Johnny Chuck has a big cousin out in the mountains of the Great West named Whistler, and on the prairies of the Great West he has a smaller cousin named Yap Yap. They are quite important members of the Marmot family, and to-morrow I’ll tell you about them if you want me to. You need not come tomorrow, Johnny Chuck, unless you want to,” she added.

Johnny Chuck hung his head, for he was a little ashamed that he had been so unwilling to come that morning.

“If you please, Mother Nature,” said he, “I think I’ll come. I didn’t know I had any close relatives, and I want to know about them.”

So it was agreed that all would be on hand at sun-up the next morning, and then everybody started for home to think over the things they had learned.

Stop here. Ch. 8, Whistler and Yap Yap, waits for Week 7.

OPEN YOUR COPY · FRIDAY

Grimm's Fairy Tales · one gentle tale

From your physical book · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Pantheon Complete Grimm's.

Choose one short gentle tale by title: "The Bremen Town Musicians" or "Sweet Porridge." Read once. Narrate. Then stop.

Never reprint Pantheon text in a packet.

Saturday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk or hymn · Ray’s (Lesson 16) · Understood Betsy ch. 5 · Harvey’s · Pilgrim’s Progress sitting · Bernstein · nature notebook · evening walk plan

8:00	Nature sit or save for evening Short morning sit, or save it for a Saturday evening walk in the Lost Pines.
8:20	Bible · Luke 20:19–26 Open your ESV to Luke 20:19–26: the question about paying taxes to Caesar. Read once. Narrate. No Awana.
8:35	Folk song, Ray’s, copywork, recitation Bold Grenadier or the hymn stanza. Lesson 16 (last Ray’s of the week). Copywork line, or the optional dictation. Genesis 1:1 from your ESV.
9:05	Literature · Understood Betsy ch. 5 “What Grade Is Betsy?” Printed. Stop at 20 minutes, even mid-chapter; finish later today or at bedtime.
9:30	Harvey’s · ~10 min Pick up from Thursday’s place. Light and oral.
9:45	Pilgrim’s Progress Worldly Wiseman’s counsel and the hill (printed, about 1,000 words). Stop at Bunyan’s verse.
10:05	Composer Bernstein, <i>Jeremiah</i>, movement II, five to eight minutes, while they draw in the nature notebook.
evening	Lost Pines walk TRACY JOINS After the day cools. Find one monarch, one bird, or one acorn or pine note. Watch for fire ants. In the notebook: draw, date, and write one sentence for her.

How to teach Saturday

No Awana. Keep Betsy to twenty minutes. The evening walk still counts as school if the morning falls apart.

Luke 20:19–26

Short. The leaders try to trap Jesus with a question about taxes. Have her narrate the coin and the answer.

Understood Betsy

Chapter 5 is long. Keep to the 20-minute cap and finish in a second short sitting today. Betsy learns she can be in different grades for different subjects, which is a lot like how Astoria's own school works.

Pilgrim's Progress

Worldly Wiseman sounds kind but points Christian the wrong way. Have her narrate what he advised and what happened at the hill. Evangelist arrives next week.

When the week is done

The shelf books stayed in the same mornings, with no second school day. Week 7 brings Island Story ch. 27, Little Duke ch. 4, CHOW from your Hillyer, and Burgess ch. 8. Seabird still waits for ~Week 19.

Tracy: Bible as long as she'll sit, songs, the evening walk. Quiet play during Betsy, Harvey's, and Pilgrim's Progress.

Bible · Luke 20:19–26

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Luke 20:19–26.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.

Paying taxes to Caesar. Both children may listen.

Understood Betsy · Chapter 5 · What Grade Is Betsy?

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CHAPTER V

WHAT GRADE IS BETSY?

After the singing the teacher gave Elizabeth Ann a pile of schoolbooks, some paper, some pencils, and a pen, and told her to set her desk in order. There were more initials carved inside, another big H. P. with a little A. P. under it. What a lot of children must have sat there, thought the little girl as she arranged her books and papers. As she shut down the lid the teacher finished giving some instructions to three or four little ones and said, "Betsy and Ralph and Ellen, bring your reading books up here."

Betsy sighed, took out her third-grade reader, and went with the other two up to the battered old bench near the teacher's desk. She knew all about reading lessons and she hated them, although she loved to read. But reading lessons...! You sat with your book open at some reading that you could do with your eyes shut, it was so easy, and you waited and waited and waited while your classmates slowly stumbled along, reading aloud a sentence or two apiece, until your turn came to stand up and read your sentence or two, which by that time sounded just like nonsense because you'd read it over and over so many times to yourself before your chance came. And often you didn't even have a chance to do that, because the teacher didn't have time to get around to you at all, and you closed your book and put it back in your desk without having opened your mouth. Reading was one thing Elizabeth Ann had learned to do very well indeed, but she had learned it all by herself at home from much reading to herself. Aunt Frances had kept her well supplied with children's books from the nearest public library. She often read three a week—very different, that, from a sentence or two once or twice a week.

When she sat down on the battered old bench she almost laughed aloud, it seemed so funny to be in a class of only three. There had been forty in her grade in the big brick building. She sat in the middle, the little girl whom the teacher had called Ellen on one side, and Ralph on the other. Ellen was very pretty, with fair hair smoothly braided in two little pig-tails, sweet, blue eyes, and a clean blue-and-white gingham dress. Ralph had very black eyes, dark hair, a big bruise on his forehead, a cut on his chin, and a tear in the knee of his short trousers. He was much bigger than Ellen, and Elizabeth Ann thought he looked rather fierce. She decided that she would be afraid of him, and would not like him at all.

"Page thirty-two," said the teacher. "Ralph first."

Ralph stood up and began to read. It sounded very familiar to Elizabeth Ann, for he did not read at all well. What was not familiar was that the teacher did not stop him after the first sentence. He read on and on till he had read a page, the teacher only helping him with the hardest words.

"Now Betsy," said the teacher.

Elizabeth Ann stood up, read the first sentence, and paused, like a caged lion pausing when he comes to the end of his cage.

"Go on," said the teacher.

Elizabeth Ann read the next sentence and stopped again, automatically.

"Go ON," said the teacher, looking at her sharply.

The next time the little girl paused the teacher laughed out good-naturedly. "What is the matter with you, Betsy?" she said. "Go on till I tell you to stop."

So Elizabeth Ann, very much surprised but very much interested, read on, sentence after sentence, till she forgot they were sentences and just thought of what they meant. She read a whole page and then another page, and that was the end of the selection. She had never read aloud so much in her life. She was aware that everybody in the room had stopped working to listen to her. She felt very proud and less afraid than she had ever thought she could be in a schoolroom. When she finished, "You read very well!" said the teacher. "Is this very easy for you?"

"Oh, YES!" said Elizabeth Ann.

"I guess, then, that you'd better not stay in this class," said the teacher. She took a book out of her desk. "See if you can read that."

Elizabeth Ann began in her usual school-reading style, very slow and monotonous, but this didn't seem like a "reader" at all. It was poetry, full of hard words that were fun to try to pronounce, and it was all about an old woman who would hang out an American flag, even though the town was full of rebel soldiers. She read faster and faster, getting more and more excited, till she broke out with "Halt!" in such a loud, spirited voice that the sound of it startled her and made her stop, fearing that she would be laughed at. But nobody laughed. They were all listening, very eagerly, even the little ones, with their eyes turned toward her.

"You might as well go on and let us see how it came out," said the teacher, and Betsy finished triumphantly.

"WELL," said the teacher, "there's no sense in your reading along in the third reader. After this you'll recite out of the seventh reader with Frank and Harry and Stashie."

Elizabeth Ann could not believe her ears. To be "jumped" four grades in that casual way! It wasn't possible! She at once thought, however, of something that would prevent it entirely, and while Ellen was reading her page in a slow, careful little voice, Elizabeth Ann was feeling miserably that she must explain to the teacher why she couldn't read with the seventh-grade children. Oh, how she wished she could! When they stood up to go back to their seats she hesitated, hung her head, and looked very unhappy. "Did you want to say something to me?" asked the teacher, pausing with a bit of chalk in her hand.

The little girl went up to her desk and said, what she knew it was her duty to confess: "I can't be allowed to read in the seventh reader. I don't write a bit well, and I never get the mental number-work right. I couldn't do ANYthing with seventh-grade arithmetic!"

The teacher looked a little blank and said: "I didn't say anything about your number-work! I don't KNOW anything about it! You haven't recited yet." She turned away and began to write a list of words on the board. "Betsy, Ralph, and Ellen study their spelling," she said. "You little ones come up for your reading."

Two little boys and two little girls came forward as Elizabeth Ann began to con over the words on the board. At first she found she was listening to the little, chirping voices, as the children straggled with their reading, instead of studying "doubt, travel, cheese," and the other words in her lesson. But she put her hands over her ears, and her mind on her spelling. She wanted to make a good impression with that lesson. After a while, when she was sure she could spell them all correctly, she began to listen and look around her. She always "got" her spelling in less time than was allowed the class, and usually sat idle, looking out of the window until that study period was over. But now the moment she stopped staring at the board and moving her lips as she spelled to herself the teacher said, just as though she had been watching her every minute instead of conducting a class, "Betsy, have you learned your spelling?"

"Yes, ma'am, I think so," said Elizabeth Ann, wondering very much why she was asked.

"That's fine," said the teacher. "I wish you'd take little Molly over in that corner and help her with her reading. She's getting on so much better than the rest of the class that I hate to have her lose her time. Just hear her read the rest of her little story, will you, and don't help her unless she's really stuck."

Elizabeth Ann was startled by this request, which was unheard of in her experience. She was very uncertain of herself as she sat down on a low chair in the corner of the schoolroom away from the desks, with the little child leaning on her knee. And yet she was not exactly afraid, either, because Molly was such a shy little roly-poly thing, with her

crop of yellow curls, and her bright blue eyes very serious as she looked hard at the book and began: "Once there was a rat. It was a fat rat." No, it was impossible to be frightened of such a funny little girl, who peered so earnestly into the older child's face to make sure she was doing her lesson right.

Elizabeth Ann had never had anything to do with children younger than herself, and she felt very pleased and important to have anybody look up to HER! She put her arm around Molly's square, warm, fat little body and gave her a squeeze. Molly snuggled up closer; and the two children put their heads together over the printed page, Elizabeth Ann correcting Molly very gently indeed when she made a mistake, and waiting patiently when she hesitated. She had so fresh in her mind her own suffering from quick, nervous corrections that she took the greatest pleasure in speaking quietly and not interrupting the little girl more than was necessary. It was fun to teach, LOTS of fun! She was surprised when the teacher said, "Well, Betsy, how did Molly do?"

"Oh, is the time up?" said Elizabeth Ann. "Why, she does beautifully, I think, for such a little thing."

"Do you suppose," said the teacher thoughtfully, just as though Betsy were a grown-up person, "do you suppose she could go into the second reader, with Eliza? There's no use keeping her in the first if she's ready to go on."

Elizabeth Ann's head whirled with this second light-handed juggling with the sacred distinction between the grades. In the big brick schoolhouse nobody EVER went into another grade except at the beginning of a new year, after you'd passed a lot of examinations. She had not known that anybody could do anything else. The idea that everybody took a year to a grade, no MATTER what! was so fixed in her mind that she felt as though the teacher had said: "How would you like to stop being nine years old and be twelve instead! And don't you think Molly would better be eight instead of six?"

However, just then her class in arithmetic was called, so that she had no more time to be puzzled. She came forward with Ralph and Ellen again, very low in her mind. She hated arithmetic with all her might, and she really didn't understand a thing about it! By long experience she had learned to read her teachers' faces very accurately, and she guessed by their expression whether the answer she gave was the right one. And that was the only way she could tell. You never heard of any other child who did that, did you?

They had mental arithmetic, of course (Elizabeth Ann thought it just her luck!), and of course it was those hateful eights and sevens, and of course right away poor Betsy got the one she hated most, 7×8 . She never knew that one! She said dispiritedly that it was 54, remembering vaguely that it was somewhere in the fifties. Ralph burst out scornfully, "56!" and the teacher, as if she wanted to take him down for showing off, pounced on him with 9×8 . He answered, without drawing breath, 72. Elizabeth Ann shuddered at his accuracy. Ellen, too, rose to the occasion when she got 6×7 , which Elizabeth Ann could sometimes remember and sometimes not. And then, oh horrors! It was her turn again! Her turn had never before come more than twice during a mental arithmetic lesson. She was so startled by the swiftness with which the question went around that she balked on 6×6 , which she knew perfectly. And before she could recover Ralph had answered and had rattled out a 108 in answer to 9×12 ; and then Ellen slapped down an 84 on top of 7×12 . Good gracious! Who could have guessed, from the way they read, they could do their tables like this! She herself missed on 7×7 and was ready to cry. After this the teacher didn't call on her at all, but showered questions down on the other two, who sent the answers back with sickening speed.

After the lesson the teacher said, smiling, "Well, Betsy, you were right about your arithmetic. I guess you'd better recite with Eliza for a while. She's doing second-grade work. I shouldn't be surprised if, after a good review with her, you'd be able to go on with the third-grade work."

Elizabeth Ann fell back on the bench with her mouth open. She felt really dizzy. What crazy things the teacher said! She felt as though she was being pulled limb from limb.

"What's the matter?" asked the teacher, seeing her bewildered face.

"Why—why," said Elizabeth Ann, "I don't know what I am at all. If I'm second-grade arithmetic and seventh-grade reading and third-grade spelling, what grade AM I?"

The teacher laughed at the turn of her phrase. "YOU aren't any grade at all, no matter where you are in school. You're just yourself, aren't you? What difference does it make what grade you're in! And what's the use of your reading little baby things too easy for you just because you don't know your multiplication table?"

"Well, for goodness' SAKES!" ejaculated Elizabeth Ann, feeling very much as though somebody had stood her suddenly on her head.

"Why, what's the matter?" asked the teacher again.

This time Elizabeth Ann didn't answer, because she herself didn't know what the matter was. But I do, and I'll tell you. The matter was that never before had she known what she was doing in school. She had always thought she was there to pass from one grade to another, and she was ever so startled to get a little glimpse of the fact that she was there to learn how to read and write and cipher and generally use her mind, so she could take care of herself when she came to be grown-up. Of course, she didn't really know that till she did come to be grown-up, but she had her first dim notion of it in that moment, and it made her feel the way you do when you're learning to skate and somebody pulls away the chair you've been leaning on and says, "Now, go it alone!"

The teacher waited a minute, and then, when Elizabeth Ann didn't say anything more, she rang a little bell. "Recess time," she said, and as the children marched out and began putting on their wraps she followed them into the cloak-room, pulled on a warm, red cap and a red sweater, and ran outdoors herself. "Who's on my side!" she called, and the children came darting out after her. Elizabeth Ann had dreaded the first recess time with the strange children, but she had no time to feel shy, for in a twinkling she was on one end of a long rope with a lot of her schoolmates, pulling with all her might against the teacher and two of the big boys. Nobody had looked at her curiously, nobody had said anything to her beyond a loud, "Come on, Betsy!" from Ralph, who was at the head on their side.

They pulled and they pulled, digging their feet into the ground and bracing themselves against the rocks which stuck up out of the playground. Sometimes the teacher's side yanked them along by quick jerks, and then they'd all set their feet hard when Ralph shouted out, "Now, ALL TOGETHER!" and they'd slowly drag the other side back. And all the time everybody was shouting and yelling together with the excitement. Betsy was screaming too, and when a wagon passing by stopped and a big, broad-shouldered farmer jumped down laughing, put the end of the rope over his shoulder, and just walked off with the whole lot of them till he had pulled them clear off their feet, Elizabeth Ann found herself rolling over and over with a breathless, squirming mass of children, her shrill laughter rising even above the shouts of merriment of the others. She laughed so she could hardly get up on her feet again, it was such an unexpected ending to the contest.

The big farmer was laughing too. "You ain't so smart as you THINK you are, are you!" he jeered at them good-naturedly. Then he started, yelling "WHOA there!" to his horses, which had begun to walk on. He had to run after them with all his might, and just climbed into the back of the wagon and grabbed the reins the very moment they broke into a trot. The children laughed, and Ralph shouted after him, "Hi, there, Uncle Nate! Who's not so smart as he thinks he is, NOW!" He turned to the little girls near him. "They 'most got away from him THAT time!" he said. "He's awful foolish about leaving them standing while he's funning or something. He thinks he's awful funny, anyhow. Some day they'll run away on him and THEN where'll he be?"

Elizabeth Ann was thinking to herself that this was one of the queerest things that had happened to her even in this queer place. Never, why never once, had any grown-up, passing the playground of the big brick building, DREAMED of such a thing as stopping for a minute to play. They never even looked at the children, any more than if they were in another world. In fact she had felt the school was in another world.

"Ralph, it's your turn to get the water," said the teacher, handing him a pail. "Want to go along?" said Ralph gruffly to Ellen and Betsy. He led the way and the little girls walked after him. Now that she was out of a crowd Elizabeth Ann felt all her shyness come down on her like a black cloud, drying up her mouth and turning her hands and feet cold as ice. Into one of these cold hands she felt small, warm fingers slide. She looked down and there was little Molly trotting by her side, turning her blue eyes up trustfully. "Teacher says I can go with you if you'll take care of me," she said. "She never lets us first-graders go without somebody bigger to help us over the log."

As she spoke they came to a small, clear, swift brook, crossed by a big white-birch log. Elizabeth Ann was horribly afraid to set foot on it, but with little Molly's hand holding tightly to hers she was ashamed to say she was afraid. Ralph skipped across, swinging the pail to show how easy it was for him. Ellen followed more slowly, and then—oh, don't you wish Aunt Frances could have been there!—Betsy shut her teeth together hard, put Molly ahead of her, took her hand, and started across. As a matter of fact Molly went along as sure-footed as a little goat, having done it a hundred times, and it was she who steadied Elizabeth Ann. But nobody knew this, Molly least of all.

Ralph took a drink out of a tin cup standing on a stump near by, dipped the pail into a deep, clear pool, and started back to the school. Ellen took a drink and offered the cup to Betsy, very shyly, without looking up. After they had all three had a drink they stood there for a moment, much embarrassed. Then Ellen said, in a very small voice, "Do you like dolls with yellow hair the best?"

Now it happened that Elizabeth Ann had very positive convictions on this point which she had never spoken of, because Aunt Frances didn't REALLY care about dolls. She only pretended to, to be company for her little niece.

"No, I DON'T!" answered the little girl emphatically. "I get just sick and tired of always seeing them with that old, bright-yellow hair! I like them to have brown hair, just the way most little girls really do!"

Ellen lifted her eyes and smiled radiantly. "Oh, so do I!" she said. "And that lovely old doll your folks have has got brown hair. Will you let me play with her some time?"

"My folks?" said Elizabeth Ann blankly.

"Why yes, your Aunt Abigail and your Uncle Henry."

"Have they got a DOLL?" said Betsy, thinking this was the very climax of Putney queerness.

"Oh my, yes!" said Molly, eagerly. "She's the one Mrs. Putney had when she was a little girl. And she's got the loveliest clothes! She's in the hair-trunk under the eaves in the attic. They let me take her down once when I was there with Mother. And Mother said she guessed, now a little girl had come there to live, they'd let her have her down all the time. I'll bring mine over next Saturday, if you want me to. Mine's got yellow hair, but she's real pretty anyhow. If Father's going to mill that day, he can leave me there for the morning."

Elizabeth Ann had not understood more than one word in five of this, but just then the school-bell rang and they went back, little Molly helping Elizabeth Ann over the log and thinking she was being helped, as before.

They ran along to the little building, and there I'm going to leave them, because I think I've told enough about their school for ONE while. It was only a poor, rough, little district school anyway, that no Superintendent of Schools would have looked at for a minute, except to sniff.

Time cap. Stop at twenty minutes even mid-chapter, and finish in a second short sitting. Chapter 6 is Week 7.

The Pilgrim's Progress · Mr. Worldly Wiseman's counsel

John Bunyan. Project Gutenberg eBook #131. Public domain. Picks up right after Week 5's stop (Christian names the wicket-gate).

WORLD. Hast thou a wife and children?

CHR. Yes; but I am so laden with this burden that I cannot take that pleasure in them as formerly; methinks I am as if I had none. [1 Cor 7:29]

WORLD. Wilt thou hearken unto me if I give thee counsel?

CHR. If it be good, I will; for I stand in need of good counsel.

WORLD. I would advise thee, then, that thou with all speed get thyself rid of thy burden; for thou wilt never be settled in thy mind till then; nor canst thou enjoy the benefits of the blessing which God hath bestowed upon thee till then.

CHR. That is that which I seek for, even to be rid of this heavy burden; but get it off myself, I cannot; nor is there any man in our country that can take it off my shoulders; therefore am I going this way, as I told you, that I may be rid of my burden.

WORLD. Who bid thee go this way to be rid of thy burden?

CHR. A man that appeared to me to be a very great and honourable person; his name, as I remember, is Evangelist.

WORLD. I beshrew him for his counsel! there is not a more dangerous and troublesome way in the world than is that unto which he hath directed thee; and that thou shalt find, if thou wilt be ruled by his counsel. Thou hast met with something, as I perceive, already; for I see the dirt of the Slough of Despond is upon thee; but that slough is the beginning of the sorrows that do attend those that go on in that way. Hear me, I am older than thou; thou art like to meet with, in the way which thou goest, wearisomeness, painfulness, hunger, perils, nakedness, sword, lions, dragons, darkness, and, in a word, death, and what not! These things are certainly true, having been confirmed by many testimonies. And why should a man so carelessly cast away himself, by giving heed to a stranger?

CHR. Why, Sir, this burden upon my back is more terrible to me than all these things which you have mentioned; nay, methinks I care not what I meet with in the way, if so be I can also meet with deliverance from my burden.

WORLD. How camest thou by the burden at first?

CHR. By reading this book in my hand.

WORLD. I thought so; and it is happened unto thee as to other weak men, who, meddling with things too high for them, do suddenly fall into thy distractions; which distractions do not only unman men, as thine, I perceive, have done thee, but they run them upon desperate ventures to obtain they know not what.

CHR. I know what I would obtain; it is ease for my heavy burden.

WORLD. But why wilt thou seek for ease this way, seeing so many dangers attend it? especially since, hadst thou but patience to hear me, I could direct thee to the obtaining of what thou desirest, without the dangers that thou in this way wilt run thyself into; yea, and the remedy is at hand. Besides, I will add, that instead of those dangers, thou shalt meet with much safety, friendship, and content.

CHR. Pray, Sir, open this secret to me.

WORLD. Why, in yonder village--the village is named Morality-- there dwells a gentleman whose name is Legality, a very judicious man, and a man of very good name, that has skill to help men off with such burdens as thine are from their shoulders: yea, to my knowledge, he hath done a great deal of good this way; ay, and besides, he hath skill

to cure those that are somewhat crazed in their wits with their burdens. To him, as I said, thou mayest go, and be helped presently. His house is not quite a mile from this place, and if he should not be at home himself, he hath a pretty young man to his son, whose name is Civility, that can do it (to speak on) as well as the old gentleman himself; there, I say, thou mayest be eased of thy burden; and if thou art not minded to go back to thy former habitation, as, indeed, I would not wish thee, thou mayest send for thy wife and children to thee to this village, where there are houses now stand empty, one of which thou mayest have at reasonable rates; provision is there also cheap and good; and that which will make thy life the more happy is, to be sure, there thou shalt live by honest neighbours, in credit and good fashion.

Now was Christian somewhat at a stand; but presently he concluded, if this be true, which this gentleman hath said, my wisest course is to take his advice; and with that he thus further spoke.

CHR. Sir, which is my way to this honest man's house?

WORLD. Do you see yonder hill?

CHR. Yes, very well.

WORLD. By that hill you must go, and the first house you come at is his.

So Christian turned out of his way to go to Mr. Legality's house for help; but, behold, when he was got now hard by the hill, it seemed so high, and also that side of it that was next the wayside did hang so much over, that Christian was afraid to venture further, lest the hill should fall on his head; wherefore there he stood still and wotted not what to do. Also his burden now seemed heavier to him than while he was in his way. There came also flashes of fire out of the hill, that made Christian afraid that he should be burned. [Ex. 19:16, 18] Here, therefore, he sweat and did quake for fear. [Heb. 12:21]

*When Christians unto carnal men give ear,
Out of their way they go, and pay for't dear;
For Master Worldly Wiseman can but shew
A saint the way to bondage and to woe.*

Stop here. Evangelist meets Christian under the hill next week.

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